HELEN L. S. DEVINE

devineh@umich.edu | [redacted] LinkedIn
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EDUCATION

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor *2020-2024*
B.S., Biopsychology, Cognition, and Neuroscience *(Honors)* GPA: 3.96

- Senior Honors Thesis: *Keep Your Friends Close and Your Phones Closer: Examining The Impact of Close Others on Compliance with Consent Requests*
    - Awarded the W.B. Pillsbury Prize for **best honors thesis** in the BCN major

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Decision-making, social influence, attitudes towards the justice system, impression management

AWARDS and HONORS

2024 W.B Pillsbury Award, University of Michigan
2024 Al Cain Honors Award, University of Michigan
2024 UofM Conference Travel Award, University of Michigan
2024 Finalist for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) Undergraduate Student Poster Award
2023 Louis Bernstein Undergraduate Psychology Award for Senior Thesis, University of Michigan
2023 Martha Muenzer Memorial Award in Psychology for Senior Thesis, University of Michigan
2023 James B. Angell Scholar, University of Michigan
2022 UofM Conference Travel Award, University of Michigan
2022 LSA Spring/Summer Scholarship, University of Michigan
2019 National Merit Commended Scholar

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Senior Honors Thesis: Impact of a Close Other on Consent Requests March 2023 - April 2024

- Developed and conducted two experiments examining the influence of a close friend on responses to and experiences of a consent request
- Managed 434 participants through recruitment, scheduling, and experimentation across online and in-lab methods
- Conducted literature review on consent requests, social pressures and biases affecting behavior, and decision-making with a close other
- Obtained independent funding for the project and organized participant compensation
- Trained 6 RAs; oversaw collection of blood pressure (BP), continuous ECG and respiration rate, and video recordings as well as self-report and behavioral measures
- Results showed that those with a friend beside them when facing an intrusive phone search request felt it would be easier to say no, but having a friend does not make them less likely to comply compared to those who are alone

Lab Manager July 2022 - May 2024
Well-Being, Health, and Interpersonal Relationships Lab – University of Michigan
Principal Investigator: Amie M. Gordon, PhD

Management Tasks

- Managed 15-person undergraduate lab; in charge of interviewing and hiring undergraduate RAs

- Led IRB application and amendment process for multiple research projects
- Created study codebooks summarizing all study measures, tasks, participant demographics scale descriptives & reliabilities, follow-up survey completion rates, and video coding results & reliabilities
- Organized wet lab procedures for two studies, compiled assay results for over 2,500 cortisol and testosterone samples
- Implemented an organizational system for storage of data to ensure security of sensitive info and ease of access
- In charge of ordering all equipment and supplies

Developing a Research-Based Dating App Study August 2023 - Present

- Led weekly meetings with an 8-person team, including two faculty PIs, for development of a research-based UM student dating app to study the initiation of romantic relationships
- Managed programming of all surveys in Qualtrics and collaborated to revise measures by piloting scales via Prolific
- Coordinated multiple focus groups of undergraduate and graduate students to seek feedback on marketing of the app
- Troubleshot design of the app; advised on recruitment strategies for undergraduate users

Simulating First-time Parenthood Study December 2021 - April 2023

- Conducted study using an infant simulator to understand how parents navigate the transition to parenthood
- Advised recruitment coordinator on best practices; assisted with training new RAs through the study paradigm
- Led a 3-person RA team through behavioral coding of videos for constructs such as stress & responsiveness; compiled reliability values and interpreted results
- Presented a poster at SPSP as first-author: results showed that new parents that experience sleep disruption caused by the arrival of a new infant and expect an inequality in childcare are more likely to experience actual inequality than those who remain optimistic about the distribution of tasks with their partner

Recruitment and Participant Coordinator August 2021 - July 2022
Well-Being, Health, and Interpersonal Relationships Lab – University of Michigan
Principal Investigator: Amie M. Gordon, PhD

Concurrent Stress in Couples Study August 2021 - October 2022

- Managed recruitment and ran in-lab sessions for a study examining how simultaneous (i.e, concurrent) versus nonconcurrent stress in romantic relationships affects interpersonal and intrapersonal well-being and support processes
- Recruited and scheduled 218 couples (using social media, flyers, and targeted emails) for an in-person lab session
- Conducted follow-up survey collection at the one month, six month, and one year mark; organized participant compensation during all study phases
- Coordinated the schedules of 15+ RAs to ensure the lab was staffed by 3 RAs during all study times
- Ran lab sessions as an experimenter guiding participants through lab tasks, including the Trier Social Stress Test (TSST), and ECG / BP / saliva sample collection
- Led a team of 5 undergraduates in assaying the saliva samples for testosterone and cortisol
- Cleaned SPSS data files of the study surveys and BP data by compiling scale values, creating partner variables, and scoring the Stroop task

Research Assistant April 2021- August 2021
Well-Being, Health, and Interpersonal Relationships Lab – University of Michigan
Principal Investigator: Amie M. Gordon, PhD

Concurrent Stress in Couples Pilot Study

- Coded videos from a pilot study for behavioral constructs such as stress, collaboration, and emotional / instrumental support
- Worked within a team of 5 to synthesize different viewpoints and resolve disagreements during coding

Research Assistant Sept 2020 - August 2021
Follow the Leader Project – University of Michigan
Principal Investigator: Elizabeth Trinh

Leadership Career Narratives Study

- Facilitated 20+ individual interviews with workplace executives and employees on their communication habits
- Conducted literature review on leadership behaviors in the workplace and generated concise summaries of findings

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PRESENTATIONS at NATIONAL CONFERENCES

Devine, H., Meyer, M., & Gordon, A. M. (2024, March). *Consent in the company of others: How social influences change intrusive requests*. Poster presented at the American Psychology Law Society Conference (AP-LS), Los Angeles, CA.

Devine, H., Meyer, M., & Gordon, A. M. (2024, February). *Consent in the company of others: How social influences change intrusive requests.* Poster presented at the main conference of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), San Diego, CA.

Devine, H., From, A., Reynaga, M., Edelstein, R., & Gordon, A. M. (2023, February). *Falling asleep at the stroller: Sleep quality and childcare division.* Poster presented at the main conference of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), Atlanta, GA.

PRESENTATIONS at UNIVERSITY CONFERENCES

Devine, H., Meyer, M., & Gordon, A. M. (2024, April). *Keep your friends close and your phones closer: Examining the impact of close others on compliance with consent requests.* Poster presented at the Psychology Undergraduate Research Forum, Ann Arbor, MI.

Devine, H., Davidson, M., & Trinh, E. (2021, April). *Follow the Leader? Rethinking Leadership and Hierarchy in the Workplace.* Presented at the annual Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program Symposium, Ann Arbor, MI.

MENTORED PRESENTATIONS

Spallas, M., Goodman, E., Rogoff, W., **Devine, H.**, Rossmaier, A., Molnar, A., & Meyer, M. (2024, April) *If someone asked for your phone, what would you do?* Poster presented at the annual Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program Symposium, Ann Arbor, MI.

Goodman, E., Rogoff, W., Spallas, M., **Devine, H.**, Rossmaier, A., Molnar, A., & Meyer, M. (2024, April) *From Request to Response: Examining the Requestee's Role in Consent Situations.* Poster presented at the annual Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program Symposium, Ann Arbor, MI.

Harwin, C., **Devine, H.**, & Gordon, A. M. (2023, April). *The support of a clouded mind: Do depressive symptoms undermine one's ability to provide support?*. Poster presented at the annual Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program Symposium, Ann Arbor, MI.

Kolias, E., **Devine, H.**, & Gordon, A. M. (2023, April). *An Attitude of Gratitude: The Impact of Feeling Appreciated by a Romantic Partner on Stress Levels Following an Acute Stressful Event.* Poster presented at the annual Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program Symposium, Ann Arbor, MI.

Weng, S., **Devine, H.**, & Gordon, A. M. (2023, April). *Teamwork is the Dreamwork: Its Transformation Before and Throughout Parenthood.* Poster presented at the annual Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program Symposium, Ann Arbor, MI.

SKILLS

- Skilled with SPSS, AcqKnowledge, MindWare, and Viso/Noldus technologies
- Proficient with Qualtrics and Prolific for survey sampling
- Extensive experience with IRB applications & amendments
- Trained in hormonal assaying of saliva samples for cortisol and testosterone
- Well-versed in ECG scoring

RELEVANT AFFILIATIONS

- American Psychology-Law Society (AP-LS) December 2023 - Present
- Student Academic Affairs Committee, Undergraduate Representative August 2023 - May 2024
    - Selected to be one of two undergraduate students to assist in reviewing policy/program updates and new course approvals in the Psychology Department
- The Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) November 2022 - Present
- Psi Chi, The International Honor Society in Psychology February 2022 - Present

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MENTORING EXPERIENCE

Ashleigh Gordon – Undergraduate Research Assistant on my Honors Thesis project
Jesse Brandner – Undergraduate Research Assistant on my Honors Thesis project
Jordan Bacharach – Undergraduate Research Assistant on my Honors Thesis project
Natalie Pierce – Undergraduate Research Assistant on my Honors Thesis project
Emma Morse – Undergraduate Research Assistant on my Honors Thesis project
Allison Youtt – Undergraduate Research Assistant on my Honors Thesis project
Calle Harwin – Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program (2022-2023)
Elizabeth Kolias – Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program (2022-2023)
Sophia Weng – Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program (2022-2023)

REFERENCES

Amie Gordon, PhD
Assistant Professor of Psychology
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor
Email: amiemg@umich.edu
Phone: (734) 763-2092

Robin Edelstein, PhD
Professor of Psychology
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor
Email: redelste@umich.edu

Tatum Jolink, PhD
Postdoctoral Research Fellow
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor
Email: tjolink@umich.edu

LSA PSYCHOLOGY
UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN

March 1, 2024

Dear Dr. Gray,

I am writing with enthusiasm regarding the Research and Outreach Coordinator position in your lab. I have just graduated from the University of Michigan with a Bachelor of Science in Biopsychology, Cognition, and Neuroscience and I look forward to continuing to expand my research and writing skills in anticipation of attending graduate school in the future. I have two years of experience as the lab manager for the WHIRLab (PI: Dr. Amie Gordon), a social psychology lab at UofM, and I am confident in my ability to be an effective research coordinator. For the past two years, I have held the only paid staff position in my lab, serving in a combined role of lab manager, researcher coordinator (of 5+ large-scale studies), office/lab administrator, undergraduate RA mentor, and outreach coordinator. I also completed a senior honors thesis this year. Based on this comprehensive experience, I believe my skill set aligns well with the needs of this position.

In addition to my strong academic background, I have honed various skills in my current lab manager position that would ensure I would be effective in this role. I have led a variety of research projects through different phases: from study conception and IRB application through recruitment and data collection to analysis and writeup. My proficiency in software tools for data collection, management, and analysis (e.g., Qualtrics, Prolific, Excel, SPSS, R) will ensure a seamless transition to your lab. Currently, I am solely managing the recruitment and data collection for a month-long intensive daily experience sampling study. Moreover, I am responsible for managing our website and coordinating external outreach with researchers interested in using our lab-developed app for running their own studies. Through this experience, I have developed professional communication skills and have been able to form collaborative relationships with other researchers.

I also look forward to developing my personal research interests and writing skills within your lab. In my senior honors thesis, I developed and conducted two studies examining how the presence of a close other affects experiences of an intrusive phone search request from an authority figure. In your lab, I am eager to explore how morality influences psychological judgments in a legal context. Though attorneys commonly present aspects of someone's moral character to influence peer judgments (e.g., decisions from a judge or jury), I am curious to examine how this process of moral typecasting is successful or not based on other aspects of a defendant's identity. For instance, are moral patients framed as less blameworthy still successful when judged by peers who are unable to relate to their victimhood? Does the success of this framing vary by the moral outrageousness of the crime? Further, I am motivated to explore how inducing feelings of action aversion can alter moral judgment and determinations of legal responsibility (e.g., guilt). Would having individuals simulate a crime lead them to judge perpetrators of the same crime to be morally worse and more guilty? I look forward to exploring these questions experimentally and using archival criminal cases.

As a candidate with extensive research experience and a motivated interest in your work, I'm excited for the opportunity to help grow your lab's outreach efforts and learn more about research on morality. Thank you for taking the time to review my application and I hope to hear from you soon.

Sincerely,
Helen Devine

1004 East Hall, 530 Church Street
Ann Arbor, MI 48109-1043

T: 734 764-2580 F: 734 764-3520
lsa.umich.edu/psych

Please recycle

Second Round Short Answer Questions

The Research and Outreach Coordinator will have the chance to conduct some original research. Please write one short paragraph outlining an original study you would like to run.

For most people, the ability to remove yourself from the salience of a punishment is key to moving forward with it. However, researchers and the legal system frequently challenge people to decide on a punishment by *imagining* what someone "deserves." To illustrate this challenge, I aim to investigate if closer proximity and higher responsibility for a punishment leads people to select less harsh punishments than those who are removed from the consequences. In addition, it's relevant to test if this choice is moderated by the moral character of the 'offender,' given that higher perceived moral agency is one of the strongest predictors for more punitive sentencing preferences (Miller & Borgida, 2016). For the study, we would first tell the participant we are running behind as a previous participant cheated on the lab task. Ask their advice on punishment: should we take no action, verbally reprimand them, or revoke their compensation? This dilemma can either be presented in a removed fashion by asking them to imagine it away from the confederate 'cheater,' or have them witness and assist the experimenter follow through with the punishment. By manipulating the backstory of the confederate, we can examine whether perceptions of higher moral agency override any hesitation to punish in either condition. I hypothesize that those forced to directly experience their choice will select less punitive punishments, and that confederates perceived as higher in moral agency will receive harsher punishments than their counterparts. This study would examine people's hesitation to punish those in front of them, even if they think they would from far away, while also understanding what may override this tendency.

Please describe any experience you have in survey development and experimental design.

I have 2 years of hands-on experience with survey development using Qualtrics in my current lab manager position, where I have programmed 25+ surveys for various studies. I am proficient in creating multi-condition surveys using survey flow. For example, I am currently leading data collection for a month long daily experience sampling study with a 2x2x2x2 design. For this, I have programmed the daily survey and 3 checkpoint surveys to ensure that participants receive the correct survey items for their condition. For my senior honors thesis, I designed and conducted both an online survey and an in-lab experiment to test my question, using both within- and between-subjects designs. In addition, I have assisted in conceptualizing 6 large-scale studies, and have been responsible for the recruitment and coordination of over a thousand participants.

One of your primary responsibilities in this job will be to write for public audiences about how our work relates to current events in psychology, politics, and other contentious issues. Please write a "mini-opinion piece" in ~200 words. Advocate for a position that you have about some broader issue that incorporates findings from psychology. You will not be evaluated on the particular position you take, but we're looking for someone who thinks deeply about psychology and how it relates to broader society. (Note: you are not expected to connect this argument to work from our lab)

Dahmer, a 2022 drama that delves into the mind and crimes of its titular character, smashed records to become Netflix's third most streamed English show of all time. Despite attempting to remain self-aware, *Dahmer* marks the peak of a concerning explosion of true crime media. The overexposure of anxiety-inducing historical tales like Dahmer's preys on availability biases and can cause misplaced panic among viewers that "killers are everywhere." In reality, the FBI notes violent crime rates are dropping. It's likely that fans of true crime see their consumption as self-protective, i.e., "If I know about a threat, then it can't hurt me." Indeed, women are the most common targets of violent crime and are twice as likely to consume true crime podcasts than men. However, this focus perpetuates the victim blaming roots of the genre. Our inability to comprehend the existence of an innocent victim forces many to dissect their stories only in the context of the crime to overcome this cognitive dissonance. By creating a laundry list of traits that listeners should avoid–"Don't run after dark! Always lock your doors!"–society rationalizes their victimhood and ignores the perpetrators to blame. In this way, true crime is a world-class pickpocket, snapping fingers in our faces with sordid tales and cautious warnings while secretly unclipping our humanity from our wrists. Our culture's fascination with exploitative crime stories is akin to "rubbernecking" at a traffic accident. In a digital era that feeds on our truest fears and funds rehashing of the worst memories, audiences just can't look away.

One of your responsibilities in this job will be to share the lab's research via short-form media such as X (Twitter). Please read the brief paper attached (intentional pain) and write a mini "Twitter thread" (800 characters max) summarizing the study and its takeaways.

Does knowing the goal behind harm change how much it hurts?
Our work shows that physical pain can sting more (and for longer) when delivered on purpose.
🧵

Pain is drastically changed by its psychological experience (see: the placebo effect) and intentional social harms are often difficult to recover from. But how about physical harm?

In the present study, people received an intentional or unintentional electric shock to the wrist from an outsider. Shocks believed to be intentional were rated as more painful. Participants also did not adjust as well; i.e., continued shocks stung more consistently when harm was intentional.

Perceptions of intention add important context when measuring pain. We may forgive and forget mistakes, but knowing that harm is intentional adds salt in the wound.